Sheet 1 — Seasonality: User Manual

Amazon.de Seller Workbook · internal v1 · 2026-08-19 · future in-app help content, easestore.de

What this sheet answers: Is demand for this niche seasonal, when does it ramp, and is the category growing or dying? Run it **before** any profit math — it takes 10 minutes per niche and kills more bad candidates than any other check.

1. Pick the right keyword (this decides everything)

Measure the **parent keyword** — the product category, phrased the way a buyer types it when they know *what* they want but not *which one*. Apply the **satisfaction test**: imagine the person who typed the keyword — would they be happy landing on your product?

Their answer	What the keyword is	Use it for
Mostly no — they wanted something else from that department	Too broad ("kueche", "kuechenzubehoer")	Nothing
Yes — now choosing between brands	**Parent** ("schubladen organizer kueche")	**This sheet**
Yes — and the phrase already names your exact variant	Child ("besteckkasten bambus 30cm")	Listing title & PPC, later

- **Children inherit the parent's curve** unless the extra word changes *why* people buy (gift sets, "kinder", seasonal use). A child you plan to target with its own driver needs its own curve check and its own stock timing.
- **Never measure a listing younger than 18 months.** A young listing's chart is launch curve + season, inseparable. Measure the category on data that existed before the listing did.

2. Get the data (Helium 10 Cerebro)

- Open Cerebro, tab **Analyze Keywords** (not *Find Keywords* — that one discovers new terms, for later).
- **Switch the marketplace flag to Amazon.de.** The default is often Amazon.com — US data is useless here.
- Enter the parent **plus its 2–3 biggest children in one query**, comma-separated. One query = one search credit regardless of how many keywords it holds — batch per niche to protect your monthly credits.
- Click the chart icon next to the search volume, set the period to 2 years / all time, export via the hamburger menu.

3. Convert weekly points to months

The history gives ~4 data points per month. Each point is a weekly *sample of the monthly volume* at that date — so **average the points inside each calendar month. Never sum.** Summing counts the same demand 4x and inflates 5-point months by ~25%, creating fake spikes and a false amplitude.

Self-check: one recent point should be in the same ballpark as the keyword's current search volume in Cerebro's main table. Same ballpark = average is correct.

4. Enter the data (yellow cells only)

- Your data window can start in **any month** — the sheet is a calendar profile, not a calendar year. The only rule: **each value goes into its calendar-month row.** Aug 2024 belongs in the Aug row of Year 1; Jan 2025 in the Jan row of Year 1; Aug 2025 in Aug of Year 2.
- "Year 1" = the older 12 months, "Year 2" = the newer 12. A 25-month window has one month too many: **drop the current, unfinished month.**
- **Alignment smell test:** does the peak land in a month that makes real-world sense? Organizers peak in January (New Year decluttering), cycling peaks in summer. A peak in a nonsense month usually means the rows are shifted.

5. Read the results

Output	Meaning	Bands / rule
Amplitude	Best month / worst month — the shape of the year	<1.5 flat · 1.5–2.5 moderate · 2.5–4 strong · >4 single-season (capital trap for a first product)
Top-4 share	How concentrated the year is	>60% = a four-month business carrying twelve months of costs
Ramp month	First month the index crosses 1.00 upward (Dec-to-Jan wrap handled)	Stock lands ~4 weeks earlier — feeds Sheet 2. A January ramp puts the on-stock date in early December (Q4 congestion): target mid-November instead
YoY / direction	Is the category growing?	>+5% growing · –5…+5% flat · –5…–15% cooling (verify on Trends) · <–15% declining (drop)
Months with data	Guard	The verdict refuses to fire until all 12 months are filled; a true zero-demand month = extreme single-season warning

Amplitude and YoY answer **different questions**: amplitude is the shape of the year, YoY is whether the tide rises or falls. A niche can pass one and fail the other — the worked example below passed amplitude (2.04) and failed direction (–8.9%).

6. Verify with Google Trends (2 minutes, free)

Trends is the independent second opinion on **shape and direction** — never on volume (its values are relative, 0–100 to the window's peak).

- **Use a broader term than on Amazon.** Trends samples all of Google; a 3-word niche phrase sits at its noise floor and draws a jagged, unreliable line. Drop the qualifier: “schubladen organizer”, not “schubladen organizer kueche”. Region Germany, 5 years.
- **Ignore the “+X% vs previous period” badge** — it compares against years when the term barely existed.
- **Read the peaks across years.** Same peak month as Cerebro = shape confirmed. Peak heights stepping down year after year = genuine decline; a boom settling onto a plateau above pre-boom levels = normalization, acceptable.
- **Vocabulary check.** German product vocabulary shifts (besteckkasten vs. organizer). Use Trends' compare mode with the traditional synonym. Both sliding together = the category is cooling. One holds while the other falls = a naming shift, not lost demand — recheck via Xray page-1 revenue (the money view, not the words view).

7. Decide

Situation	Action
Flat / moderate amplitude + flat or growing direction	Pass. Continue to Sheet 3 (unit economics)
Strong amplitude, ramp still reachable	Sheet 2: is the order-by date still in the future?
Single-season, or zero-demand months	Drop as a first product
Cooling direction	Trends + vocabulary check decide; enter only with a strong differentiation angle
Declining direction	Drop unless Trends shows a clearly temporary dip

Enter amplitude, top-4 share and the direction verdict into the niche's column on Sheet 5 (scorecard).

Worked example (real run)

schubladen organizer kueche, Amazon.de, 24 months to Aug 2026: amplitude **2.04** (moderate, pass), top-4 share **41.6%** (pass), peak **Jan** / trough **Jun** — the New-Year-decluttering pattern, so the row alignment is confirmed. Ramp **Jan**: stock by mid-November, order by ~September. But YoY –**8.9%**, negative in 10 of 12 months: COOLING. Trends 5y (“schubladen organizer”): January peaks 73 → 100 (2023) → 92 → 68 → 55 — a boom peaking in early 2023 and stepping down since, now at pre-boom levels. Pending the vocabulary check vs. “besteckkasten”, the niche **fails the flat-or-rising rule** despite friendly seasonality. That is the sheet doing its job: amplitude said “fine”, direction said “no”.

Common mistakes (each produces confident wrong answers)

- Measuring a department term (“kuechenzubehoer”) — meaningless demand, competition and curve.
- Measuring your exact variant — too thin; noise reads as seasonality.
- **Summing** weekly points instead of averaging.
- Typing the export in row order instead of calendar-month rows (shifts the whole curve).
- Trusting a jagged Trends line on a 3-word term instead of broadening it.
- Reading the “+X%” Trends badge as growth.
- Using BSR for amplitude — ranks are relative and systematically understate seasonal swings.
- Measuring a listing under 18 months old instead of the category.

Educational material, not financial advice. Data sources: Helium 10 Cerebro (Amazon.de), Google Trends (DE, 5y), Amazon Product Opportunity Explorer as cross-check. Method: classical multiplicative decomposition (Hyndman & Athanasopoulos, otexts.com/fpp3).